Biljana Taneska · Science teacher

Biology words · Glossary

Grade 7 · IB MYP 2 · Unit 2 The Secrets of a Long Life · 73 words in simple English

Name: _____ Class: _____ My first language: _____

👀 Read the word and look at the picture. ✍️ Write the word in your language. 🗣️ Say the example sentence out loud. 🙈 Cover the meaning and test yourself.

1 · Health and the body | 2 · Circulatory system | 3 · Respiratory system | 4 · Alcohol, caffeine and smoking | 5 · Digestive system | 6 · Diet and nutrition | 7 · Microbes and disease

💚 1 · Health and the body



1 health *noun*

Being well in body, mind and with other people, not only having no illness.

e.g. Sleep and exercise are good for your health.

In my language: _____



2 disease *noun · diseases*

An illness that stops part of the body from working properly.

e.g. Flu is a disease caused by a virus.

In my language: _____



3 glucose *noun*

A simple sugar. Cells use it in respiration to release energy.

e.g. Your muscles use glucose when you run.

In my language: _____



4 agonist *noun · agonists*

The muscle that contracts (gets shorter) to move a part of the body.

e.g. The biceps is the agonist when you bend your arm.

In my language: _____



5 antagonist *noun · antagonists*

The muscle that relaxes while its partner muscle contracts.

e.g. The triceps is the antagonist when you bend your arm.

In my language: _____



6 fast-twitch fibres *noun*

Muscle cells that work for short, fast bursts of activity.

e.g. Sprinters use lots of fast-twitch fibres.

In my language: _____

2 · Circulatory system



7 blood *noun*

The red liquid that carries oxygen, food and waste around the body.

e.g. Blood is pumped by the heart.

In my language: _____



8 cardiac muscle *noun*

The special muscle of the heart. It never gets tired.

e.g. Cardiac muscle contracts about 70 times a minute.

In my language: _____



9 atrium *noun · atria*

One of the two top chambers of the heart. It receives blood.

e.g. Blood from the lungs enters the left atrium.

In my language: _____

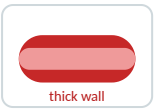


10 ventricle *noun · ventricles*

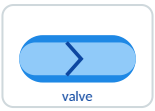
One of the two bottom chambers of the heart. It pumps blood out.

e.g. The left ventricle pumps blood to the whole body.

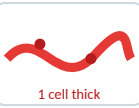
In my language: _____



11 artery *noun · arteries*
A blood vessel that carries blood away from the heart.
e.g. You can feel your pulse in an artery.
In my language: _____



12 vein *noun · veins*
A blood vessel that carries blood back to the heart.
e.g. Veins have valves so blood cannot flow backwards.
In my language: _____



13 capillary *noun · capillaries*
The smallest blood vessel. Its wall is only one cell thick.
e.g. Oxygen passes from capillaries into the cells.
In my language: _____



14 aorta *noun*
The biggest artery. It carries blood from the heart to the body.
e.g. The aorta leaves the left ventricle.
In my language: _____



15 vena cava *noun*
The biggest vein. It brings blood from the body back to the heart.
e.g. The vena cava enters the right atrium.
In my language: _____



16 pulmonary artery *noun*
The artery that carries blood from the heart to the lungs.
e.g. Blood in the pulmonary artery has little oxygen.
In my language: _____



17 pulmonary vein *noun*
The vein that carries blood full of oxygen from the lungs to the heart.
e.g. The pulmonary vein brings blood to the left atrium.
In my language: _____



18 red blood cell *noun · red blood cells*
A blood cell that carries oxygen. It has no nucleus.
e.g. Red blood cells contain haemoglobin.
In my language: _____



19 white blood cell *noun · white blood cells*
A blood cell that fights germs and helps protect you from disease.
e.g. White blood cells make antibodies.
In my language: _____



20 pacemaker *noun · pacemakers*
A small group of cells in the heart that sets how fast it beats.
e.g. An artificial pacemaker can help a weak heart.
In my language: _____

3 · Respiratory system



21 lungs *noun · lung*
Two organs in the chest where oxygen enters the blood.
e.g. Your lungs fill with air when you breathe in.
In my language: _____



22 trachea (windpipe) *noun*
The tube that carries air from the throat to the lungs.
e.g. Rings of cartilage keep the trachea open.
In my language: _____



23 bronchus *noun · bronchi*
One of the two tubes that branch from the trachea into the lungs.
e.g. Each lung has one bronchus.
In my language: _____



24 alveolus *noun · alveoli*
A tiny air sac in the lungs where gas exchange happens.
e.g. There are millions of alveoli in your lungs.
In my language: _____



25 diaphragm *noun*
A sheet of muscle under the lungs that helps you breathe.
e.g. The diaphragm moves down when you breathe in.
In my language: _____



26 ribs *noun · rib*
The curved bones that protect the heart and lungs.
e.g. Your ribs move up and out when you breathe in.
In my language: _____



27 intercostal muscles *noun*
The muscles between the ribs. They move the ribs when you breathe.
e.g. Intercostal muscles pull the ribs up and out.
In my language: _____



28 breathing *noun · breathe (verb)*
Moving air in and out of the lungs.
e.g. Breathing gets faster when you exercise.
In my language: _____



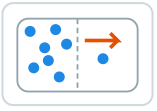
29 inhalation *noun · inhale (verb)*
Breathing in: air moves into the lungs.
e.g. During inhalation the chest gets bigger.
In my language: _____



30 exhalation *noun · exhale (verb)*
Breathing out: air moves out of the lungs.
e.g. During exhalation the chest gets smaller.
In my language: _____



31 gas exchange *noun*
Oxygen goes into the blood and carbon dioxide comes out, in the alveoli.
e.g. Gas exchange happens in the lungs.
In my language: _____



32 diffusion *noun · diffuse (verb)*
Particles spreading from where there are many to where there are few.
e.g. Oxygen moves into the blood by diffusion.
In my language: _____



33 aerobic respiration *noun*
Releasing energy from glucose using oxygen. It makes carbon dioxide and water.
e.g. Jogging uses aerobic respiration.
In my language: _____



34 anaerobic respiration *noun*
Releasing energy from glucose without oxygen. In muscles it makes lactic acid.
e.g. A sprint uses anaerobic respiration.
In my language: _____

4 · Alcohol, caffeine and smoking



35 addictive *adjective · addiction (noun)*
Making you want to use something again and again, so it is hard to stop.
e.g. Nicotine is very addictive.
In my language: _____



36 alcohol *noun*
A drug in drinks like beer and wine. It slows down the brain.
e.g. Alcohol harms the liver.
In my language: _____



37 caffeine *noun*
A drug in coffee, tea and cola that makes you feel awake.
e.g. Too much caffeine can stop you sleeping.
In my language: _____



38 nicotine *noun*
The addictive, poisonous drug in tobacco and most vapes.
e.g. Nicotine makes the heart beat faster.
In my language: _____



39 cancer *noun*
A serious disease where cells divide out of control and form a lump.
e.g. Smoking can cause lung cancer.
In my language: _____



40 stimulant *noun · stimulants*
A drug that speeds up the brain and the body.
e.g. Caffeine is a stimulant.
In my language: _____



41 depressant *noun · depressants*
A drug that slows down the brain and the body.
e.g. Alcohol is a depressant.
In my language: _____

🍽 5 · Digestive system



42 digestion *noun · digest (verb)*
Breaking food down into small molecules that the body can absorb.
e.g. Digestion starts in the mouth.
In my language: _____



43 ingestion *noun · ingest (verb)*
Taking food into the body through the mouth.
e.g. Eating an apple is ingestion.
In my language: _____



44 absorption *noun · absorb (verb)*
Small food molecules passing from the intestine into the blood.
e.g. Most absorption happens in the small intestine.
In my language: _____



45 alimentary canal *noun*
The long tube from the mouth to the anus that food passes through.
e.g. The alimentary canal is about 9 m long.
In my language: _____



46 oesophagus (food pipe) *noun*
The tube that carries food from the mouth to the stomach.
e.g. Muscles push food down the oesophagus.
In my language: _____



47 stomach *noun*
A muscular bag that churns food and mixes it with acid and enzymes.
e.g. The stomach kills germs with acid.
In my language: _____



48 liver *noun*
A big organ that makes bile and removes harmful substances from the blood.
e.g. The liver breaks down alcohol.
In my language: _____



49 bile *noun*
A green liquid made by the liver. It helps to digest fats.
e.g. Bile breaks fat into tiny drops.
In my language: _____



50 small intestine *noun*
The long, thin part of the gut where food is digested and absorbed.
e.g. Food molecules enter the blood in the small intestine.
In my language: _____



51 villus *noun · villi*
A tiny finger shape on the wall of the small intestine. It helps absorption.
e.g. Villi give the intestine a huge surface.
In my language: _____



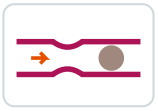
52 large intestine *noun*
The wide part of the gut where water is absorbed from waste.
e.g. The large intestine makes the waste solid.
In my language: _____



53 rectum *noun*
The end part of the gut where waste (faeces) is stored.
e.g. Faeces wait in the rectum.
In my language: _____



54 anus *noun*
The opening at the end of the gut where waste leaves the body.
e.g. Faeces leave the body through the anus.
In my language: _____



55 peristalsis *noun*
Waves of muscle squeezing that push food along the gut.
e.g. Peristalsis moves food down the oesophagus.
In my language: _____

🥗 6 · Diet and nutrition



56 diet *noun · diets*
The food and drink a person usually eats.
e.g. A balanced diet has food from every group.
In my language: _____



57 nutrition *noun · nutrients*
Getting the food substances (nutrients) the body needs to grow and stay healthy.
e.g. Good nutrition helps you grow.
In my language: _____



58 carbohydrate *noun · carbohydrates*
A nutrient that gives energy, e.g. sugar and starch.
e.g. Bread and pasta are rich in carbohydrates.
In my language: _____



59 protein *noun · proteins*
A nutrient for growth and repair, made of amino acids.
e.g. Eggs, fish and beans contain protein.
In my language: _____



60 amino acids *noun · amino acid*
The small building blocks that proteins are made of.
e.g. Proteins are digested into amino acids.
In my language: _____



61 lipid (fat) *noun · lipids*
Fats and oils. They store energy and keep you warm.
e.g. Butter and oil are lipids.
In my language: _____



62 vitamin *noun · vitamins*
A substance needed in small amounts to stay healthy.
e.g. Oranges contain vitamin C.
In my language: _____



63 mineral *noun · minerals*
A substance from the ground, like calcium or iron, needed in small amounts.
e.g. Milk gives you the mineral calcium.
In my language: _____



64 fibre *noun*
The part of plant food we cannot digest. It helps food move through the gut.
e.g. Brown bread and vegetables have lots of fibre.
In my language: _____

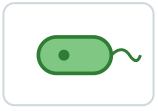


65 water *noun*
A clear liquid every cell needs. Most of your body is water.
e.g. Drink water when you exercise.
In my language: _____

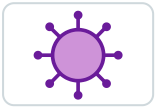
7 · Microbes and disease



66 pathogen *noun · pathogens*
A microbe (germ) that causes disease.
e.g. Some bacteria are pathogens.
In my language: _____



67 bacteria *noun · bacterium*
Very small living cells. Some cause disease, many are useful.
e.g. Bacteria in yoghurt are useful.
In my language: _____



68 virus *noun · viruses*
A tiny germ that can only reproduce inside living cells.
e.g. A virus causes the common cold.
In my language: _____



69 parasite *noun · parasites*
A living thing that lives on or in another one and harms it.
e.g. Head lice are parasites.
In my language: _____



70 immune system *noun*
The parts of the body, like white blood cells, that fight pathogens.
e.g. Your immune system makes antibodies.
In my language: _____



71 antibody *noun · antibodies*
A protein made by white blood cells that sticks to a pathogen.
e.g. Vaccines help your body make antibodies.
In my language: _____



72 antibiotic *noun · antibiotics*
A medicine that kills bacteria. It does not work on viruses.
e.g. Penicillin is an antibiotic.
In my language: _____



73 antibiotic resistance *noun*
When bacteria are no longer killed by an antibiotic.
e.g. Using antibiotics too often causes antibiotic resistance.
In my language: _____

A–Z · find a word

absorption	44 · p. 4	carbohydrate	58 · p. 5	oesophagus (food pipe)	46 · p. 4
addictive	35 · p. 3	cardiac muscle	8 · p. 1	pacemaker	20 · p. 2
aerobic respiration	33 · p. 3	depressant	41 · p. 3	parasite	69 · p. 5
agonist	4 · p. 1	diaphragm	25 · p. 2	pathogen	66 · p. 5
alcohol	36 · p. 3	diet	56 · p. 4	peristalsis	55 · p. 4
alimentary canal	45 · p. 4	diffusion	32 · p. 3	protein	59 · p. 5
alveolus	24 · p. 2	digestion	42 · p. 4	pulmonary artery	16 · p. 2
amino acids	60 · p. 5	disease	2 · p. 1	pulmonary vein	17 · p. 2
anaerobic respiration	34 · p. 3	exhalation	30 · p. 3	rectum	53 · p. 4
antagonist	5 · p. 1	fast-twitch fibres	6 · p. 1	red blood cell	18 · p. 2
antibiotic	72 · p. 5	fibre	64 · p. 5	ribs	26 · p. 2
antibiotic resistance	73 · p. 5	gas exchange	31 · p. 3	small intestine	50 · p. 4
antibody	71 · p. 5	glucose	3 · p. 1	stimulant	40 · p. 3
anus	54 · p. 4	health	1 · p. 1	stomach	47 · p. 4
aorta	14 · p. 2	immune system	70 · p. 5	trachea (windpipe)	22 · p. 2
artery	11 · p. 2	ingestion	43 · p. 4	vein	12 · p. 2
atrium	9 · p. 1	inhalation	29 · p. 3	vena cava	15 · p. 2
bacteria	67 · p. 5	intercostal muscles	27 · p. 3	ventricle	10 · p. 1
bile	49 · p. 4	large intestine	52 · p. 4	villus	51 · p. 4
blood	7 · p. 1	lipid (fat)	61 · p. 5	virus	68 · p. 5
breathing	28 · p. 3	liver	48 · p. 4	vitamin	62 · p. 5
bronchus	23 · p. 2	lungs	21 · p. 2	water	65 · p. 5
caffeine	37 · p. 3	mineral	63 · p. 5	white blood cell	19 · p. 2
cancer	39 · p. 3	nicotine	38 · p. 3		
capillary	13 · p. 2	nutrition	57 · p. 4		

Opposites

- artery ↔ vein
- inhalation ↔ exhalation
- aerobic respiration ↔ anaerobic respiration
- stimulant ↔ depressant
- agonist ↔ antagonist
- red blood cell ↔ white blood cell
- atrium ↔ ventricle
- health ↔ disease

💡 Make your own word cards: write the English word on the front, and the picture and the word in your language on the back. Practise with a partner.